[dd] It would have been far better for the retreating army to have travelled at night when the snow would have been frozen, and the Ghilzai unable to shoot with any accuracy: the Afghan Mujehedin, travelling in the same terrain in the 1980s always travelled at night for these very reasons. But this was an army untrained and ill-equipped for either mountain or winter warfare.

[ee] The army could have taken the far less dangerous route through the Lautaband Pass. Why they did not do this remains a mystery. In the second Afghan War this was the route used by the British army thus bypassing the terrible Khord Kabul and Tezin Passes where most of the killing took place.

[ff] In reality the Jabbar Khel and Kharoti Ghilzai who patrolled these passes would not have felt any compunction about disobeying the Barakzai chiefs whom the Ghilzais despised almost as much as they hated the Sadozai. Macnaghten had reneged on their payments and now they wanted to get their own back.

[gg] British women below officer class were left to fend for themselves. According to the tribesmen I talked to in these passes, a great number ended up in local harems, while the less desirable ones were sold as slaves.

[hh] It was Khatri traders from Multan and Shikarpur who dominated the Central Asian trade between Bukhara and Sindh. See Arup Banerji, *Old Routes: North Indian Nomads and Bankers in Afghan, Uzbek and Russian Lands*, New Delhi, 2011, p. 2.

[ii] When the writers Nancy and Louis Dupree visited Gandamak in the 1970s they found bones, fragments of Victorian weaponry and military equipment still lying in the scree above the village.

[jj] These opinions should not be especially surprising or taken as examples of Stockholm Syndrome. British attitudes towards the Afghans have traditionally been both positive and admiring. Mountstuart Elphinstone thought the Afghans resembled Scottish Highlanders (see the excellent analysis of this in Ben Hopkins, *The Making of Modern Afghanistan*, London, 2008), and in the late nineteenth and early twentieth century British officers identified with the Afghans and saw their frontier fighting in terms of school playing-field athletics – attitudes which seeped into Kipling's writing. This idea of the 'noble Pashtun' is still alive and well among British forces in Afghanistan in the most recent occupation who tend to view the Afghans as 'natural fighters'. For an especially kitsch example of this trope, see the Sylvester Stallone movie *Rambo III* (1988).

[kk] These women may have been water carriers (saqau), a traditional role for Pashtun women during battle.

[ll] The same tactics were used by the Taliban against the orchards and vineyards of the Shomali Plain when they finally lost patience with the mainly Tajik villages of Parwan in the 1990s.

[mm] His body was eventually removed by Pollock and reburied in Park Street cemetery in Calcutta, not far from the tomb erected for whatever remains Lady Macnaghten had managed to retrieve of her husband.